Design Process Checklist

A repeatable path from a blank brief to a resolved scheme. Work top to bottom - do not skip the middle.

1. Read the brief

- [ ] Separate requirements (rooms, areas, budget) from intentions (who, feeling)
- [ ] List every constraint and every opportunity
- [ ] Build an area schedule / accommodation list
- [ ] Write the brief back in your own words

2. Site analysis

- [ ] Sun path and orientation
- [ ] Prevailing wind
- [ ] Noise sources
- [ ] Access and movement
- [ ] Views (to keep and to screen)
- [ ] Topography and levels
- [ ] Context and local character
- [ ] One sentence: 'This site wants a building that...'

3. Concept

- [ ] One organising idea, responding to site + brief
- [ ] Can you explain it in a single sentence?
- [ ] Does it help you make the next ten decisions?

4. Develop through iteration

- [ ] Sketch three genuinely different options
- [ ] Model early - card, massing, digital
- [ ] Study it in section, not just plan
- [ ] Push each option until it breaks, then combine what worked

5. Resolve

- [ ] Does it stand up? (structure and buildability)
- [ ] Does it work for the person inside? (walk it at eye level)
- [ ] Plan and section fully coordinated

6. Communicate

- [ ] A clear narrative for the crit
- [ ] The key drawings that prove the idea
- [ ] You can defend every move

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